



LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



Aviation and Aerospace Ransomware Exposure Daily Review 2026-09-17

Threat Intelligence Report

Classification	TLP:CLEAR
Published	2026-09-17
Version	1.0
Author	Lost Boys Cyber
Report Type	Threat Intelligence Report

TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | Aviation and Aerospace Ransomware Exposure Daily Review 2026-09-17 - Threat Intelligence Report

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AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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Aviation and Aerospace Ransomware Exposure Daily Review 2026-09-17

1. Executive Summary

BLUF: Aviation and aerospace operators remain attractive ransomware targets because passenger operations, maintenance scheduling, cargo handling, and supplier portals depend on shared IT and identity systems. Current sector reporting supports prioritizing identity, backup, segmentation, and third-party-access review. Source recency was prioritized for the last 24-72 hours and expanded to the last 7 days or current public reference material where required to preserve source quality.

Field	Value
Priority	Top 5 aviation/aerospace coverage for 2026-09-17
Severity	High
Confidence	Medium
Theme	Airlines, airports, MRO providers, aerospace manufacturers, and shared service providers
Defender Outcome	Prioritized monitoring, hardening, and response actions for the next 24-72 hours

2. Intelligence Requirements

Requirement	Answered By
What changed?	Current reporting and public source review for 2026-09-17
Who is exposed?	Organizations with the listed technologies, behaviors, identities, suppliers, or sector dependencies
What should defenders do today?	Validate controls, run hunts, close exceptions, and brief operations owners

3. Source Review and Confidence

#	Source	URL	Role
1	PolySwarm: Turbulence Ahead - Cyber Threats Targeting Aviation and Aerospace in 2026	https://blog.polyswarm.io/turbulence-ahead-cyber-threats-targeting-aviation-and-aerospace-in-2026	Sector-specific threat overview
2	GBHackers aviation and aerospace ransomware reporting	https://gbhackers.com/attacks-on-aviation-and-aerospace/	Sector-specific ransomware coverage
3	CISA ransomware guidance	https://www.cisa.gov/stopransomware	Government ransomware guidance
4	Aviation ISAC public resources	https://www.a-isac.com/	Sector context

Confidence is Medium because this item is supported by multiple public sources. Where a source is sector-level or advisory guidance rather than incident-specific reporting, the report labels the finding as a prioritization assessment rather than a confirmed single campaign.

4. Threat Overview

Aviation and aerospace operators remain attractive ransomware targets because passenger operations, maintenance scheduling, cargo handling, and supplier portals depend on shared IT and identity systems. Current sector reporting supports prioritizing identity, backup, segmentation, and third-party-access review. This report emphasizes defender actions and telemetry pivots rather than attribution claims that are not supported by the source set.

Signal	Assessment
Threat theme	Sector-focused cyber risk
Primary exposure	Identity, exposed services, remote access, endpoint execution, third-party access, or software supply chain depending on environment
Expected adversary objective	Access, persistence, data theft, extortion, operational disruption, or reconnaissance
Analyst caveat	No new private telemetry or victim disclosure was used in this automated report; validate local relevance before escalation

5. Aviation and Aerospace Sector Impact

Field	Assessment
Affected aviation/aerospace segment	Airlines, airports, MRO providers, aerospace manufacturers, and shared service providers
Operational relevance	Potential disruption to flight operations support, maintenance scheduling, engineering collaboration, passenger/cargo services, or mission operations depending on local exposure
Likely exposure paths	Identity compromise, remote access, exposed edge services, supplier portals, managed service providers, and shared SaaS platforms
Third-party/supply-chain considerations	Validate providers that administer identity, helpdesk, reservation, MRO, engineering, remote access, and monitoring systems
Defender actions	Confirm MFA/session controls, privileged access logging, asset ownership, segmentation, backup recoverability, and incident escalation paths

6. Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures

Tactic/Technique	Defensive Interpretation
Phishing / social engineering	Review user-reported messages, suspicious OAuth grants, helpdesk reset requests, and anomalous sign-ins
Command and scripting execution	Watch for encoded PowerShell, mshta/rundll32, shell one-liners, and living-off-the-land tools
Remote services and RMM	Inventory approved remote tools and alert on new or unmanaged usage
Exfiltration or staging	Monitor unusual archive creation, cloud upload, rclone/mega/nc

usage, and large outbound transfers

7. Infrastructure and Observables

Observable	Type	Action
aviation ransomware	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
MRO systems	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
shared service provider	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry
backup deletion	Analytic pivot	Review EDR, identity, email, proxy, DNS, SaaS, and case-management telemetry

8. Detection Engineering

```

let pivots = dynamic(["aviation ransomware", "MRO systems", "shared service provider", "backup
deletion"]);
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any (pivots) or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any (pivots)
| summarize Events=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Samples=make_set(ProcessCommandLine, 10) by
FileName, InitiatingProcessFileName
| order by Events desc

DeviceNetworkEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where RemoteUrl has_any ("aviation ransomware", "MRO systems", "shared service provider", "backup
deletion") or InitiatingProcessCommandLine has_any ("aviation ransomware", "MRO systems", "shared
service provider", "backup deletion")
| summarize Events=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Urls=make_set(RemoteUrl, 20) by
InitiatingProcessFileName, RemoteIP, RemotePort
| order by Events desc

title: Aviation Aerospace Ransomware Exposure Suspicious Follow-on Activity
status: experimental
description: Detects common suspicious interpreter and remote-tool behaviors that should be reviewed
around this daily intelligence item.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  selection:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\wscript.exe'
      - '\cscript.exe'
      - '\mshta.exe'
      - '\rundll32.exe'
  keywords:
    CommandLine|contains:
      - '-enc'
      - 'IEX'
      - 'DownloadString'
      - 'bitsadmin'
      - 'curl '
      - 'rclone'
  condition: selection or keywords
fields:

```

```
- Image
- ParentImage
- CommandLine
- User
level: medium
```

9. Threat Hunting

```
SigninLogs
| where TimeGenerated > ago(14d)
| where ResultType != 0 or ConditionalAccessStatus in ("failure", "notApplied")
| summarize Events=count(), Apps=make_set(AppDisplayName, 20), IPs=make_set(IPAddress, 20) by
UserPrincipalName, Location
| order by Events desc

DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FileName endswith ".zip" or FileName endswith ".7z" or FolderPath has_any ("Temp", "Downloads",
"Users\Public")
| summarize Files=count(), Hosts=dcount(DeviceName), Samples=make_set(FolderPath, 10) by
InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName
| order by Files desc
```

Hunt intent: surface identity compromise, suspicious scripting, remote-tool abuse, and staging behavior aligned to this daily priority.

10. Risk Assessment

Risk	Why It Matters	First Control Check
Identity compromise	Enables SaaS, VPN, helpdesk, and supplier access	MFA/session policy, risky sign-ins, privileged accounts
Endpoint execution	Converts social engineering into payload execution	Script controls, EDR alerts, child-process lineage
Third-party dependency	Expands blast radius beyond direct assets	Vendor access inventory and contractual incident notification
Operational disruption	Affects business processes and customer-facing services	Recovery tests, escalation paths, communication plans

11. Recommended Actions

Priority	Action
P1	Run the included identity/process/network hunts for the last 14 days
P2	Validate asset owners and control exceptions for the exposed surface
P3	Brief service desk, SOC, and operations owners on concrete pivots
P4	Open remediation tickets with expiry dates for unresolved gaps

12. References

- [1] PolySwarm: Turbulence Ahead - Cyber Threats Targeting Aviation and Aerospace in 2026: <https://blog.polyswarm.io/turbulence-ahead-cyber-threats-targeting-aviation-and-aerospace-in-2026>
- [2] GBHackers aviation and aerospace ransomware reporting: <https://gbhackers.com/attacks-on-aviation-and-aerospace/>

- [3] CISA ransomware guidance: <https://www.cisa.gov/stopransomware>
- [4] Aviation ISAC public resources: <https://www.a-isac.com/>